RUGBY BRAIN PROFILE:

Name	Surname	Team	Position 1	Position 2	Position 3

In the next section we are going to determine the unique thought preferences that formed you as rugby player by determining your rugby brain profile. It is an important starting-point because if you are able to understand your own brain preference, you will not only obtain insight into your own behaviour, but also into that of your team-mates which may differ a great deal from yours.

It is very important not to rush through this section and to read the questions carefully and answer them in total honesty. **Remember, there are no right or wrong answers. Everybody eventually ends with a grant total of 150. Therefore, although our profiles differ which indicates our uniqueness, it has nothing to do with right or wrong, good or bad. When working through the questionnaire, remember the following:**

- Read every question closely and react according to your preference (not as you think others want you to react).
- Allocate your marks accurately every time.
- When you have answered all the questions, write down the marks accurately on the score-card at the end of the specific section.
- Add the marks in each column carefully (there are 4 co-

lumns) and to make sure that you have added correctly, add your four totals at the end of each column.

The four totals must give you a grand total of 150.

- Now make a dot on the circle, more or less where your mark must be and link the dots. (There is a completed example to help you drawing the profile.)
- Do not rush! There is no time limit – enjoy it!

Now determine your own rugby brain profile

Allocate marks at every question as follows:

- 4 for your first choice
- 3 for your second choice
- 2 for your third choice
- 1 for your last choice

Fill your choice into the block next to the question. After completing the questionnaire, fill in your marks on the score-card at the end of the questionnaire.

1. If I think about a rugby match that I must play I prefer to ...
   a. develop a positive attitude about the match ☐
   b. think very specifically about the match ☐
   c. think of the match in general ☐
   d. remember the plans for the match that we have practised ☐

2. I prefer a captain who ...
   a. is realistic and objective ☐
   b. wants to listen ☐
   c. has an open mind ☐
   d. is well-organised ☐

3. I prefer team situations ...
   a. that are friendly and relaxed ☐
   b. where advanced skills are appreciated ☐
   c. that are exciting and not always the same ☐
   d. where everybody is well-prepared ☐

4. If the coach discusses tactics for the match with the team, I prefer him to ...
   a. do it in a focussed manner without flippancy ☐
   b. do it quickly so that we can get to the field ☐
   c. do it systematically, step by step ☐
   d. make the team members part of the discussion ☐

5. I prefer a coach who ...
   a. plans efficiently ☐
   b. focusses strongly on team spirit ☐
   c. exchanges ideas freely ☐
   d. can analyse the match well ☐

6. If I change to another club (province, school, etc.) I will ...
   a. objectively study and analyse the advantages of the change ☐
   b. try to determine how the change fits into my future rugby plans ☐
   c. wonder how I will fit in with my new team-mates ☐
   d. wonder how the change will influence my familiar circumstances ☐

7. While practising on the field, I prefer ...
   a. to practise in a relaxed atmosphere ☐
   b. to practise the movements in a dedicated manner ☐
   c. to get clearly formulated instructions ☐
   d. many variations in the training programme ☐

8. I prefer my team-mates to describe me as somebody who ...
   a. does not say unpleasant things about them ☐
   b. speaks plainly ☐
   c. practises with dedication and diligence ☐
   d. always makes plans on the field ☐

9. I prefer the game tactics to be ...
   a. analysed thoroughly
   b. applied unchanged during the match
   c. discussed by al the team members
   d. only a starting-point that leaves room for deviation

10. I enjoy the company of team-mates who ...
   a. know what they want
   b. are imaginative and always try new things
   c. are punctual and do not make their team-mates wait
   d. are friendly and easy-going

11. If I play in a match, I prefer ...
   a. that we will make no mistakes
   b. the team spirit to be very positive
   c. that we stick to the plan for the match
   d. to do things on the spur of the moment

12. In the change-room before the match, I prefer to ...
   a. summon my passion for the match
   b. concentrate on the match without being disturbed
   c. go over the match in my mind for the last time
   d. wait in a relaxed mood for the beginning of the match

13. When the ball is kicked directly at me, my first reaction is to ...
   a. start playing according to a practised movement
   b. look for support
   c. start with a counter-attack
   d. keep my focus

14. As a new member of the team, I will give preference to ...
   a. a well-organised rugby environment
   b. acceptance by the players and coaches
   c. very specific guidelines about what is expected of me
   d. opportunities

15. When I play rugby ...
   a. I am constantly on the lookout for new possibilities and options
   b. I am calculated and do not allow my feelings to play a role
   c. I am always thoroughly prepared
   d. I am a team player and not an individual

Completion of your profile score-card

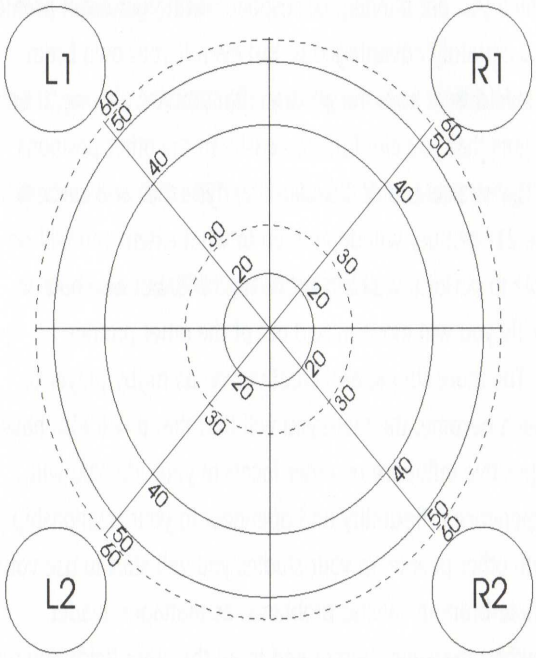
It may appear time consuming but it is important to complete the following score-card very accurately. Note that the a, b, c and d do not appear at the same place every time.

- Write down the marks that you have allocated for every question accurately and then add up every column separately.
- When you add up your FOUR totals at the bottom of the page, your grand total must be 150.

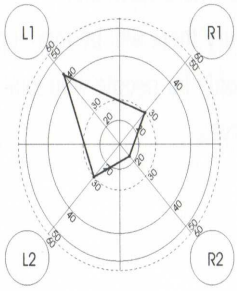
1	b	d	a	c	
2	a	d	b	c	
3	b	d	a	c	
4	a	c	d	b	
5	d	a	b	c	
6	a	d	c	b	
7	c	b	a	d	
8	b	c	a	d	
9	a	b	c	d	
10	a	c	d	b	
11	a	c	b	d	
12	b	c	a	d	
13	d	a	b	c	
14	c	a	b	d	
15	b	c	d	a	
TOTAL					= 150
	L1	L2	R2	R1	

Now fill in your totals in the small circles and then make a dot more or less where your score lies. Then link the dots

to determine your parent brain profile. (Take a look at the example below if you experience any problems.)



Example



BRAIN PROFILE:

L1: Left Quadrant (Top Left) **Logic:**
Focus
Think Logically
Dedicated and focused
Think concretely and rationally and to utilise specific knowledge in the process
To operate from memory
To make logical conclusions
To act in line with definite training methods

R1: Right Quadrant (Top Right) **Creativity:**
Individualism
Imagination
Being different
Renewal
Unusualness
Intuition
Looking at the big picture
Experimenting and acting on the spur of the moment

L2: Left Quadrant (Bottom Left) **Systematic Approach:**
Preference for systematic, step by step approach
Discipline and order
Learnt patterns
Rules and regulations
Systematic approach
Thorough planning

R2: Right Quadrant (Bottom Right) **Emotional Intelligence:**
Group cohesion
Teamwork
Unity
Mutual support
Strong passion
The development of feeling and emotion
Communication and interaction

Reference:

Botha, N. and Neethling, K. (1999). CREATIVE RUGBY, Don't just sweat it, think it! Carpe diem. First Edition.